

Assignment 1: Morphology

Linguistics 201 – Fall 2026

(100 pts total)

Please **do not seek external information such as the internet or AI**. If you need an **extension**, please ask before the deadline.

Part 1. Grammaticality and Acceptability

Consider the following sentences and determine which are grammatical vs. ungrammatical in English. (*3 points/item, 9 points total*)

- For each ungrammatical sentence:
 - Place an asterisk (that is, a star *) in front of the sentence,
 - E.g., *Apple the green is.
 - Change the sentence to make it grammatical, and
 - Explain in your own words how your version is different from the example.
- Recall that non-standard language is still grammatical, as long as it sounds natural to speakers. Indicate whether any of the sentences are non-standard and explain in your own words what makes them non-standard.

1. Books the are on brown the table.

2. The teacher said that her was late.

3. The children ain't playing in the yard.

Part 2. Morphemes

The following words are made up of one or more morphemes. For each word, identify its component morphemes, and answer the following questions. (*4 points/word, 16 points total*)

- Is the word simple or compound? Is the word monomorphemic or polymorphemic?
- For each morpheme in the word, is it a root, prefix, or suffix? Is it a free or bound morpheme? If it is an affix, is it inflectional or derivational?
- Example: ***singers***
 - *singers*: simple, polymorphemic
 - *sing*: root, free
 - *-er*: suffix, bound, derivational
 - *-s*: suffix, bound, inflectional

1. rearrangement

2. firetruckdriver

3. Massachusetts

4. thickeners

Part 3. Morphological Processes

Examine each of the words below and **identify** which of the following morphological process(es) is involved in their formation: affixation, compounding, reduplication, alternation, or suppletion. For each process you identify, briefly **explain** how it is involved. Note that for some words, multiple processes may be involved. (4 points/item, 16 points total)

Example: speak → misspoke

prefixation – the prefix mis- is added to the root speak

alternation – the vowel in the root speak changes to spoke

1. bad → worse

2. fire, fight → firefighter

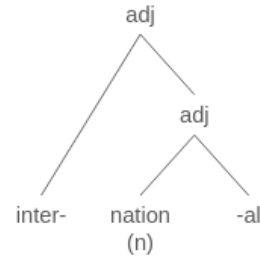
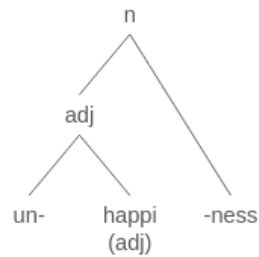
3. take → retook

4. like → like-liked

Part 4. Morphological Trees.

Draw a morphological **tree diagram** for each of the following words, following the examples. Make sure to label the part of speech of the root, as well as the part of speech at each level above the root. Some words may have more morphemes than others. (5 points/tree, 20 points total)

Examples: *unhappiness, international*



1. unaffordable

2. reformer

3. impersonal

4. nonrefundable

Part 5. Allomorphs

Consider the following data from **Turkish** (a Turkic language spoken in Turkey) and answer the questions below. The accusative case (ACC) in Turkish is an affix added to a noun to show that it is the definite direct object of the verb—that is, the specific thing being acted on e.g., *kitap* ‘book’ *kitabı* ‘the book’. (8 points total)

Singular	Plural	Singular + ACC	Plural + ACC
adam ‘man’	adamlar ‘men’	adamı ‘the man’	adamları ‘the men’
kız ‘girl’	kızlar ‘girls’	kızı ‘the girl’	kızları ‘the girls’
ev ‘house’	evler ‘houses’	evi ‘the house’	evleri ‘the houses’
ip ‘rope’	ipler ‘ropes’	ipi ‘the rope’	ipleri ‘the ropes’
top ‘ball’	toplar ‘balls’	topu ‘the ball’	topları ‘the balls’
kul ‘servant’	kullar ‘servants’	kulu ‘the servant’	kulları ‘the servants’
göl ‘lake’	göller ‘lakes’	gölü ‘the lake’	gölleri ‘the lakes’
gül ‘rose’	güller ‘roses’	gülü ‘the rose’	gülleri ‘the roses’

1. What are the plural and accusative morphemes in Turkish? Identify all the **allomorphs** of the plural and accusative morphemes that are present in the data. (4 points)
2. Is the plural morpheme a suffix or infix? Explain your reasoning, making reference to concepts discussed in class and specific words in the dataset above. (4 points)

Part 6. Morphological Analysis

Consider the following data from Zulu, a language spoken in South Africa, and answer the questions that follow. (31 points total)

A. Consider the following nouns in Zulu:

umfazi	“married woman”	abafazi	“married women”
umfani	“boy”	abafani	“boys”
umzali	“parent”	abazali	“parents”
umfundisi	“teacher”	abafundisi	“teachers”
umbazi	“carver”	ababazi	“carvers”
umlimi	“farmer”	abalimi	“farmers”
umdlali	“player”	abadlali	“players”
umfundi	“reader”	abafundi	“readers”

- a. What is the morpheme meaning “singular” in Zulu? (2 point)

- b. What is the morpheme meaning “plural” in Zulu? (2 point)

- c. List the Zulu roots to which the singular and plural morphemes are attached and give their meanings. (16 points)

B. The following Zulu verbs are derived from noun stems by adding a verbal suffix:

fundisa	"to teach"	funda	"to read"
lima	"to cultivate"	baza	"to carve"

- d. Compare these words to the words in section A that are related in meaning, for example, *umfundisi* "teacher," *abafundisi* "teachers," *fundisa* "to teach." What is the derivational suffix that specifies the category verb? (2 points)
- e. What is the nominal suffix (i.e., the suffix that forms nouns)? (2 points)
- f. State the morphological noun formation rule in Zulu. (3 points)
(a rule is written in the form of "*something* + *something* = *something*". For example, the rule of English plurals is written as *noun* + "-s" = *plural noun*.)
- g. What is the stem morpheme meaning "read"? (2 points)
- h. What is the stem morpheme meaning "carve"? (2 points)